Move-Out Cleaning for Landlords & Property Managers

Free quick study · November 12, 2026 · General information, not financial or legal advice. Results are not guaranteed.

1. What it is

A move-out (turnover) clean is a deep clean of an empty home or apartment after a tenant leaves: every room top to bottom, inside cabinets, closets and appliances, baseboards, doors, sills and floors, finished with a walkthrough against the landlord's checklist. Landlords and property managers need it done fast, every time a unit turns over, so the next tenant can move in.

2. What customers pay (published 2026 figures)

Measure	Published figure	Source
Typical move-out clean	$120–$420; national average $360	Angi (2026)
Move-in / move-out clean	$150–$500	HomeGuide
Empty apartment, 1 bed / 1 bath	$90–$130	HomeGuide
Empty apartment, 3 bed / 2 bath	$180–$300	HomeGuide
Hourly, per cleaner	$25–$50	Angi
Labor time	4–8 hours per move-out	Housecall Pro (via Small Business Toolbox)

3. Startup cost breakdown (solo, using your own car)

Item	Typical range	Source
Cleaning tools (vacuum, mop, bucket, microfiber)	$100–$300	Xero
Cleaning supplies (all-purpose, disinfectant, glass)	$50–$100	Xero
Safety gear (gloves, masks, eye protection)	$25–$50	Xero
Business registration & licenses	$50–$300	Xero
General liability insurance	$300–$1,000 / year (Insureon avg. ~$59/month)	Xero; Insureon via MSMETOOLS
Marketing (cards, flyers, simple website)	$100–$300	Xero
Typical total, residential	about $1,000–$3,000	Xero

4. Requirements checklist

✓ WITHOUT AI	✗ with AI
✓ NO REAL ESTATE needed	✗ needs real estate
✓ NO BUILDING needed	✗ needs building
✓ NO OFFICE needed (home-based)	✗ needs office
✓ NO LAND needed	✗ needs land

You do need: supplies, insurance, a local business registration/license where required, and a way to get to jobs (your own car works to start).

5. Steps to start

• Check your city/state licensing rules (the SBA business registration guide is a good starting point) and register the business.
• Buy general liability insurance. Many landlords and managers will ask for a certificate of insurance before the first job.
• Build a starter kit: vacuum, mop, microfiber, scrubbers, all-purpose cleaner, disinfectant, glass cleaner, gloves.
• Write a one-page move-out checklist (kitchen, bathrooms, inside appliances, cabinets, baseboards, floors, windows).
• Set flat prices by unit size using the published ranges above, plus add-ons (oven, fridge, carpets, junk removal).
• Do 1–2 practice cleans (friends or family) and take before/after photos for your portfolio.

6. How to get the first clients

• Skip homeowners at first. Pitch property managers, apartment leasing offices and small landlords: they turn units over all year.
• Call or visit local property management companies with your checklist, prices and before/after photos. Offer a discounted first unit.
• Ask real estate agents who handle rentals, and list on free local directories and community groups.
• Promise speed: same-week or next-day turnover is what managers value most, because an empty unit earns no rent.
• After every job, ask for a review and the next unit.

7. How it earns

You charge a flat fee per unit (published averages: $120–$420, national average $360 per Angi). Your costs are supplies, gas, insurance and your time. Illustration only, not a promise: 2 apartment move-outs per week at $250 each would be $500/week in revenue before costs. Repeat work from one manager is what makes it steady.

8. Risks

• Uneven demand: move-outs cluster around month-end and in busy moving seasons.
• Very dirty units can take far longer than quoted. Always see photos or do a walkthrough, and add a heavy-condition fee.
• Damage or injury claims: this is why insurance matters.

• Slow payment from some managers. Agree on terms in writing and invoice the same day.
• Physical work with chemicals; use proper safety gear.

9. Our rating

Difficulty: 2/5	Speed to profit: 4/5	First income: ~2–4 weeks (our estimate)

Want a detailed study for your project or an AI assistant to run your business? Message us.

Sources (read Nov 12, 2026): Angi, "How Much Does a Move-Out Clean Cost?" angi.com/articles/how-much-cost-move-out-cleaning.htm · HomeGuide, maid service and apartment cleaning cost guides, homeguide.com/costs/maid-service-cost and homeguide.com/costs/apartment-cleaning-prices · Small Business Toolbox, "Move-Out Cleaning Checklist (and How to Price It)" (citing Housecall Pro) · Xero US, "How to start a cleaning business" xero.com/us/guides/how-to-start-a-cleaning-business · MSMETOOLS, "How to Start a Cleaning Business in 2026" (citing Insureon). Prices vary by city, home size and condition.